

Delayed-Onset Hepatocellular Injury After Prolonged Sulmadine Use: A Case Report

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J. Fictional Clin. Case Reports, Vol. 12, Issue 5, pp. 401–404 (2026)

Abstract. We report a fictional case of delayed-onset hepatocellular injury in a patient on long-term Sulmadine (fictional anticonvulsant), with serial liver enzyme measurements documenting the injury and recovery course over three weeks.

Case Presentation

A 52-year-old fictional female patient had been maintained on Sulmadine 300 mg daily for eight months for seizure control when she presented with jaundice and fatigue. She had no history of liver disease and denied alcohol use. Physical examination revealed mild scleral icterus without hepatomegaly.

Serial liver function tests were obtained at presentation and during follow-up, summarized in the table below.

Day	ALT (U/L)	AST (U/L)
0 (presentation)	540	410
7	210	180
21	38	31

Discussion

The delayed onset (eight months into therapy) is notable and consistent with reports of idiosyncratic, non-dose-dependent hepatotoxicity for this drug class. Enzyme trends showed steady improvement after Sulmadine discontinuation, supporting a causal relationship. Continued antiepileptic management required substitution with an alternative agent under neurology guidance.

References

1. Ndiaye C, Anand F. Idiosyncratic hepatotoxicity in long-term anticonvulsant therapy. Fictional Hepatol Case Rev. 2025;7(2):66-70.